

Sustainability Report — University College Cork

Prepared **with reference to** the GRI Standards · compiled 2026-08-30

About this report. It is generated from University College Cork's public AASHE STARS 3.0 submission, mapped onto the GRI Standards. It covers 78 GRI disclosures across 13 standards. Where a disclosure cannot be answered from STARS data, the report says so and why, rather than omitting the question. **How the figures got here — and why they can be trusted.** Every number in this document was copied by code from the extracted STARS dataset. The language model that wrote the prose was never shown a figure: it wrote named placeholders and the values were substituted afterwards, so it could not alter, round or invent one. After substitution the finished text is scanned, and the build fails if any number in it cannot be traced back to the source data. The model chose the sentences; it did not choose the numbers. **What that guarantee does not cover.** It applies to figures. Qualitative statements are drawn from the institution's own STARS narrative answers, but no mechanical check confirms that a sentence describing them is faithful. **"With reference to", not "in accordance with".** GRI reserves **in accordance** for reports answering every Universal Disclosure plus all disclosures for each material topic. This report does not, so it makes the weaker and correct claim. **Source and attribution.** [University College Cork STARS Report](<https://reports.aashe.org/institutions/university-college-cork-national-university-of-ireland-cork-co-corcaigh/report/2026-03-05/>), AASHE. STARS data is publicly accessible and used here with attribution to AASHE; it is not openly licensed.

The organisation and its reporting

Organisational Profile and Boundary

University College Cork is a public higher education institution. Its physical footprint and primary operational activities encompass its main campus, satellite campuses, a medical school, and a museum.

In accordance with Disclosure 2-2, the reporting boundary defined for this report covers all main campus facilities and satellite locations under the direct management of the University College Cork Buildings and Estates office. Certain affiliated bodies and operational entities are excluded from this reporting boundary. Specifically, subsidiary companies—including Campus Accommodation, the Mardyke Arena, the Student Centre, and the Irish Management Institute in Dublin—are not included. In addition, rented multi-tenant buildings fall outside the operational scope of this report.

Reporting Process and External Assurance

The compilation of this report was led by Dr Maria Kirrane, Head of Sustainability and Climate. With respect to energy and climate accounting under GRI 305, the performance period evaluated for Scope 1 and Scope 2 greenhouse gas emissions corresponds to 2024.

In alignment with Disclosure 2-5, external verification was obtained for specific climate indicators. The institution's reported Scope 1 and Scope 2 emissions figures were subject to independent external assurance provided by Sustineo, the university's contracted carbon footprint provider.

Limitations and Data Gaps

This report reflects the boundaries and structures of the underlying data source, resulting in specific reporting omissions:

- **Organisational details and business model (GRI 2-1 and GRI 2-6):** The legal name, headquarters location, countries of operation, full value chain description, and broader market sectors served are not reported beyond the physical campus attributes noted.
- **Financial boundary alignment (GRI 2-2):** The source data does not specify whether the reporting boundary differs from the university's consolidated financial statements, nor does it detail how minority interests are consolidated.
- **Reporting period and contact details (GRI 2-3):** Reporting periods vary across individual credit topics rather than following a single institutional reporting period. Furthermore, the reporting frequency, publication date, and official public contact details are not recorded.
- **Restatements of information (GRI 2-4):** Restatements of information are not reported, as the data source represents independent assessment snapshots without comparative restatement mechanisms.
- **Assurance details (GRI 2-5):** Specific assurance standards, the precise level of assurance obtained, inherent limitations of the audit process, and the formal nature of the relationship with the assurance provider are not detailed in the source material.

Activities and workers

Workforce Size and Structure

University College Cork records an employed workforce of 3,643. This metric represents the full-time equivalent capacity supporting the university's academic, operational, and administrative functions.

Framework Alignment and Data Limitations

The reported figure carries specific methodological boundaries when evaluated against GRI Standards. Under GRI 2-7, full-time equivalent measures total operational workload capacity rather than a direct headcount, meaning two half-time staff members are aggregated as one unit. The primary reporting source collects a single undifferentiated figure. Consequently, the institution does not currently disaggregate its employee data into the specific categories required by Disclosure 2-7, such as breakdowns by employment contract (permanent and temporary), employment type (full-time and part-time), gender, or region.

Furthermore, data required under GRI 2-8 regarding workers who are not employees is not reported. Disclosure 2-8 requires tracking the total number and contractual relationships of workers whose work is controlled by the organisation but who are not directly employed. The reporting frameworks utilised by the university monitor employees and students only. While third-party contracting firms operate on campus, the source data records contracting entities rather than the headcount of individual personnel performing work under those service agreements.

Material topics

The sustainability topics covered in this report are aligned with the framework established by the Sustainability Tracking, Assessment & Rating System (STARS), developed by the Association for the Advancement of Sustainability in Higher Education for the higher-education sector. University College Cork did not run an independent materiality assessment to identify or prioritize institution-specific topics. Consequently, the topics reported reflect the standardized STARS structure rather than a bespoke materiality determination.

Operational and Institutional Objectives

Under GRI 3-2, the reporting scope encompasses standard sector areas where University College Cork has adopted measurable sustainability objectives: * Campus operations * Teaching, learning, and research * Equity and social justice * Administration and finance * Campus and community engagement

Within campus operations, the University maintains measurable targets set out in its Sustainability and Climate Action Plan. These include commitments to exceed national reduction targets for Scope 1 and Scope 2 greenhouse gas emissions, as well as achieving net zero total greenhouse gas emissions. Operational objectives also cover adapting estate management policies and infrastructure for climate resilience, securing funding for carbon reduction programmes, applying a Living Laboratory model to campus sustainability solutions, and preserving green spaces in accordance with the campus masterplan.

Governance and Management

Institutional management under GRI 3-3 is led by the Head of Sustainability and Climate Action within the Office of Sustainability and Climate Action. This office oversees governance bodies including the Green Campus Committee, the Green Forum, and a University Leadership Team subcommittee focused on sustainability and climate action.

Key outcomes coordinated through this structure include the publication of the institutional Sustainability and Climate Action Plan, securing external Green Flag accreditation, maintaining international university sustainability rankings, and managing the Green Campus Living Laboratory Fund. The institution maintains public commitments to sustainability through published strategic plans and external charter participation.

Data Limitations and Omissions

- **GRI 3-1 Process to determine material topics:** Not reported. The University does not carry out a dedicated materiality assessment. Process details regarding how actual and potential impacts on the economy, environment, and people were identified, prioritised, or informed by stakeholder engagement are therefore unavailable.
- **GRI 3-2 List of material topics:** The reported topic areas represent fixed STARS credit categories rather than an institution-specific impact evaluation, and historical comparisons against previous reporting periods are not captured by this dataset.
- **GRI 3-3 Management of material topics:** Management mechanisms are reported institution-wide rather than on a topic-by-topic basis. The source framework does not record specific positive or negative impacts, does not differentiate direct operational involvement from business relationships, does not separate harm prevention from remediation, and does not report lessons learned.

Governance

Governance Structure and Composition

The highest decision-making body of University College Cork is the Governing Authority. Decision-making representation on the Governing Authority encompasses key internal campus constituencies, including academic staff, non-managerial staff, and student representatives. Academic staff representation on the Governing Authority is determined through democratic election by university staff.

Delegation of Responsibility

Responsibility for coordinating sustainability across campus constituencies is delegated to specific administrative officers. Dedicated roles within the university include the Head of Sustainability and Climate Action, the Sustainability Support Officer, and the

Greenshoots coordinator, who focuses specifically on student engagement. These officers lead and coordinate sustainability initiatives across operational and academic units.

Role in Sustainability Reporting

In relation to GRI 2-14, executive endorsement of the institution's sustainability reporting submission is evidenced by formal cover documentation submitted alongside institutional assessment data.

Limitations and Unreported Disclosures

The available source material presents several reporting limitations. Regarding governance composition under GRI 2-9, the data confirms constituency representation but does not supply full numerical details on overall board size, executive status, independence, tenure, or demographic background. For GRI 2-13, designated officers carry operational responsibility, but formal reporting lines and the frequency of updates to the Governing Authority are not specified. Under GRI 2-14, executive cover documentation indicates executive endorsement rather than formal review and approval of material topics by the highest governance body.

Where GRI framework indicators request information on governing body behaviour and oversight processes, the source material contains no records. Specifically, the data does not address: - Nomination and selection mechanisms for governing body members under Disclosure 2-10 - Leadership structure and conflict management regarding the chair under Disclosure 2-11 - Direct oversight of impact due diligence and stakeholder engagement under Disclosure 2-12 - Processes for preventing and disclosing conflicts of interest under Disclosure 2-15 - Communication channels and volume of critical concerns under Disclosure 2-16 - Measures to advance the collective sustainability knowledge of board members under Disclosure 2-17 - Performance evaluation of the highest governance body under Disclosure 2-18 - Remuneration policies and determination processes under Disclosure 2-19 and Disclosure 2-20 - The annual compensation ratio under Disclosure 2-21, which is left uncalculated in the reported data.

Strategy, policies and practices

Sustainability Vision and Commitments

University College Cork (UCC) details its strategic direction through its Sustainability and Climate Action Plan, which builds upon its prior sustainability strategy. The university aims to embed sustainability principles across education, research, campus infrastructure, administration, and community engagement. Key institutional goals focus on campus waste elimination and reaching carbon neutrality.

In addition to internal strategies, UCC is subject to statutory requirements from the Irish government to reduce its absolute greenhouse gas emissions. The university publishes

annual climate action roadmaps outlining the measures planned to meet these statutory targets.

Governance and Embedding Policy Commitments

Coordination of sustainability efforts is directed by the Head of Sustainability and Climate Action through the Office of Sustainability and Climate Action. This office oversees key institutional bodies, including the Green Campus Committee, the Green Forum, and the University Leadership Team Subcommittee on Sustainability and Climate Action. Operational achievements include administering the Green Campus Living Laboratory Fund, securing Green Flag accreditation from the Foundation for Environmental Education, and participating in global sustainability rankings.

To integrate sustainability into university operations, UCC enforces a code of conduct for suppliers that outlines social and environmental expectations. In addition, regular sustainability-focused training opportunities are made available to non-academic staff.

Grievances and Mechanisms for Raising Concerns

UCC maintains published policies outlining employee rights, grievance resolution, and mechanisms for raising concerns. Accessible documentation covers grievance procedures, whistleblower protections, and frameworks to address sexual violence and harassment. Operational policies recognize fundamental constitutional rights, including freedom of association, and facilitate union representation through partners such as the Irish Federation of University Teachers.

Summary of Governance Disclosures and Limitations

Certain GRI disclosures cannot be fully reported due to the structure of available data: - **Strategy and Commitments (Disclosure 2-22, GRI 2-23, GRI 2-28):** Under Disclosure 2-22, the published strategic vision is recorded without attribution to a named executive signatory. For GRI 2-23 and GRI 2-28, reported commitments center on broad sustainability and statutory emissions targets rather than explicit human rights due diligence or UN Guiding Principles, and organizational association memberships are not captured. - **Embedding Commitments (Disclosure 2-24):** Available information highlights institutional achievements and general non-academic training rather than formal internal allocations of responsibility, integration into business relationships, or training on specific policy commitments. - **Grievance and Whistleblower Mechanisms (Disclosure 2-25, Disclosure 2-26):** Records confirm the publication of policies for employees, but do not detail operational workflows, mechanism effectiveness, or coverage for external stakeholders and business relationships. - **Compliance with Laws and Regulations (GRI 2-27):** Information regarding non-compliance with laws, regulations, or associated fines is not collected within the underlying dataset, leaving GRI 2-27 unreported.

Stakeholder engagement

Consultation Mechanisms for Students and Staff

University College Cork consults with internal stakeholders through established deliberative bodies and governance forums. Student participation in strategic decisions, policy formulation, and institutional planning is facilitated primarily through the UCC Student Forum. Modeled on the structure of the Irish Citizens' Assembly, this forum serves as a platform for deliberative democracy, embedding student input into university decision-making to enhance institutional transparency and integrity.

Academic staff are consulted via the Academic Leadership Forum, a non-executive body that acts as a strategic reference group for academic leadership. This forum facilitates institutional dialogue on key operational and strategic matters, including admissions quotas, postgraduate entry, and cross-university initiatives, prior to formal submission to the Academic Council or Academic Board. Additionally, the forum coordinates university inputs for national higher education calls, promotes interdisciplinary initiatives, and supports integration between teaching and research activities across faculties.

Local Community Engagement

The university maintains engagement mechanisms for local community members and neighbourhood organisations. Consultation occurs through both targeted ad hoc interactions and standing channels, including direct engagement with community bodies such as the Magazine Road Residents Association. University College Cork maintains ongoing structures through which non-affiliated community-based organisations can participate democratically in institutional governance processes. External community stakeholder engagement is further embedded in academic practices through engaged research frameworks, which require societal partners, service users, and public representatives to be consulted during the design and execution of research projects.

Framework Limitations and Omissions

While the institution maintains structures for consulting core campus groups, reporting under Disclosure GRI 2-29 is subject to scope limitations imposed by the underlying data collection framework. The framework focuses on predefined campus constituencies and does not record details regarding how stakeholders are systematically identified, how the effectiveness of engagement is evaluated, or how specific external groups—such as suppliers, customers, or vulnerable populations—are consulted.

Regarding Disclosure GRI 2-30, the university does not report the percentage of its total employee workforce covered by collective bargaining agreements. The available reporting standards track institutional policies on freedom of association and contractor wage thresholds, but do not collect total collective bargaining coverage data across all staff categories.

Environmental performance

Energy Performance

To align with the reporting requirements of GRI 302, University College Cork tracks its energy consumption across all operations. The university's total annual energy consumption is 55,148.70 Megawatt-hours. Under Disclosure 302-1, energy consumption is typically reported in joules; however, the data here is recorded in megawatt-hours and can be converted to gigajoules by applying standard conversion factors.

Of this total, electricity consumption accounts for 32,599.70 Megawatt-hours and total stationary fuel consumption is 22,549 Megawatt-hours. The university's annual renewable energy consumption stands at 0.70 Megawatt-hours. It should be noted that this renewable energy figure includes purchased renewable electricity, which is broader than the scope of GRI 302-1-b (which focuses solely on fuel from renewable sources). The university's consumption of renewable stationary fuels is 0 Megawatt-hours. Total heating and cooling obtained from off-site sources is 0 Megawatt-hours. The university exported 0 Megawatt-hours of on-site renewable electricity.

The breakdown of stationary fuel consumption by fuel type includes natural gas of 22,549 Megawatt-hours, heating oil of 0 Megawatt-hours, coal or coke of 0 Megawatt-hours, and propane or LPG of 0 Megawatt-hours. Other stationary fuels are reported as zero, making this a complete representation of the university's stationary fuel mix.

In terms of energy intensity (GRI 302-3), the annual energy consumption per person is 2,139.20 Kilowatt-hours. The denominator for this metric is the university's population of full-time equivalent students and employees. The annual energy consumption per unit of floor area is 195.31 Kilowatt-hours per square meter. The denominator for this metric is the gross floor area of the university's buildings.

Water Performance

Under GRI 303, the university monitors its water withdrawal and interactions with water as a shared resource. The physical water quantity risk for the main campus is classified as low-medium. The university harvests rainwater on-site for storage and use, though the exact volume harvested is not currently quantified. This risk assessment is limited to the main campus and does not describe the specific withdrawal, consumption, or discharge processes, nor does it detail stakeholder engagement on shared water resources across all campuses.

For water withdrawal (GRI 303-3), the total water withdrawal is 54,153 Cubic meters. Potable water from off-site sources (third-party water) is 54,153 Cubic meters. Potable water from on-site sources is 0 Cubic meters. To align with GRI 303-3, which requires reporting in megalitres, these cubic-metre figures must be divided by a standard conversion factor. Because on-site abstraction is zero, third-party water constitutes the entirety of the university's water withdrawal. This reporting does not include a breakdown of water stress areas, which is a limitation of the current data set.

Emissions Performance

The greenhouse gas emissions inventory for University College Cork is calculated by its contracted supplier, Sustineo, in accordance with the GHG Protocol standards and ISO 14064-1. The methodology uses a top-down approach to assess expenditure data and identify hotspots, followed by a bottom-up methodology using primary data. Data is also submitted annually to the Sustainable Energy Authority of Ireland.

For Scope 1 emissions (GRI 305-1), the annual Scope 1 GHG emissions are 6,215.78 Metric tons of CO₂ equivalent. This includes 5,517 Metric tons of CO₂ equivalent from stationary combustion, 62.78 Metric tons of CO₂ equivalent from mobile combustion, and 636 Metric tons of CO₂ equivalent from fugitive emissions. Emissions from biogenic sources are 0 Metric tons of CO₂ equivalent. Process emissions are currently blank or not reported.

For Scope 2 emissions (GRI 305-2), the annual Scope 2 GHG emissions are 8,144 Metric tons of CO₂ equivalent. The location-based emissions from off-site electricity are 8,144 Metric tons of CO₂ equivalent. Market-based emissions from off-site electricity are 8,144 Metric tons of CO₂ equivalent. Emissions from off-site heating and cooling are 0 Metric tons of CO₂ equivalent.

For Scope 3 emissions (GRI 305-3), the university reports emissions from business travel of 3,565 Metric tons of CO₂ equivalent and commuting emissions of 20,991 Metric tons of CO₂ equivalent. Emissions from purchased goods and services are 1,572 Metric tons of CO₂ equivalent. Emissions from capital goods are 0 Metric tons of CO₂ equivalent. Fuel- and energy-related activities not included in Scope 1 or Scope 2 account for 3,318 Metric tons of CO₂ equivalent. Emissions from waste generated in operations are currently blank or not reported.

The emissions intensity (GRI 305-4) is 557.01 Kilograms of CO₂ equivalent per person (using full-time equivalent students and employees as the denominator) and 50.86 Kilograms per square meter per unit of floor area (using gross floor area in square metres as the denominator).

Regarding emissions reductions (GRI 305-5), the baseline year for Scope 1 and Scope 2 emissions is 2017. This baseline was established by the government of Ireland for all public bodies. The baseline Scope 1 and Scope 2 emissions are 19,460 Metric tons of CO₂ equivalent. The percentage reduction in Scope 1 and Scope 2 emissions from this baseline is 26.21%. The adjusted net Scope 1 and Scope 2 emissions are 14,359.78 Metric tons of CO₂ equivalent. The university holds 0 Metric tons of CO₂ equivalent of third-party certified carbon offsets. Because these offsets are zero, the gross and net percentage reductions are identical.

Waste Performance

The university manages waste-related impacts (GRI 306-2) through several active programmes. It operates a surplus programme to store, sell, donate, or reuse university-

owned items that are no longer needed. A reuse programme is also available for employees and students to donate personal items. The university has eliminated certain forms of single-use disposable plastic on-site. A hazardous waste management protocol is in place to minimise the use of hazardous materials. For organic waste, compostable lunchboxes are accepted in the university's food waste bins.

For waste generation (GRI 306-3), the annual non-hazardous waste generated is 520 Metric tons. This represents a subset of total waste, as hazardous waste tonnages are not quantified. The annual construction and demolition waste generated is 6,914.08 Metric tons.

For waste diverted from disposal (GRI 306-4), the total non-hazardous waste diverted is 242 Metric tons. This is recovered through recycling (183 Metric tons), composting (59 Metric tons), and preparation for reuse (0 Metric tons). For construction and demolition waste, the total diverted from disposal is 6,837.95 Metric tons. This is recovered through recycling (5,675.22 Metric tons), and preparation for reuse (1,162.73 Metric tons).

For waste directed to disposal (GRI 306-5), non-hazardous waste disposed of to a landfill or incinerator is 278 Metric tons. Construction and demolition waste disposed of to a landfill or incinerator is 76.13 Metric tons.

Supplier Environmental Assessment

The university's supplier code of conduct does not include environmental expectations that exceed regulatory compliance. The percentage of bid solicitations that identify supplier sustainability considerations is 21%. This metric does not represent the actual percentage of new suppliers screened using environmental criteria (GRI 308-1), as the denominator is bid solicitations rather than new suppliers, and "sustainability considerations" is broader than environmental criteria.

Limitations and Unreported Disclosures

Several disclosures under the GRI standards are not reported due to data limitations or applicability. GRI 301-1, GRI 301-2, and GRI 301-3 (materials used, recycled inputs, and reclaimed products) are not reported because the university does not manufacture physical products. GRI 302-2 (energy consumption outside the organisation) is not tracked. GRI 302-4 (energy reductions in absolute joules) is not reported as STARS does not collect baseline energy data. GRI 302-5 (reductions in energy requirements of products) is not applicable. GRI 303-2 (water discharge-related impacts and effluent quality standards) is not monitored. GRI 305-6 (ozone-depleting substances) and GRI 305-7 (NO_x, SO_x, and other air emissions) are not quantified. GRI 306-1 (waste generation process descriptions and value chain impacts) is not detailed. GRI 308-2 (negative environmental impacts in the supply chain) is not tracked at the supplier level. Specific data gaps in the current reporting cycle include Scope 1 process emissions, Scope 3 emissions from waste generated in operations, and market-based Scope 2 emissions.

Social and economic performance

Pay and Employment Conditions

University College Cork provides standard remuneration and benefits to its workforce. The wage floor for regular and permanent employees is 16.40. For student workers, the local hourly minimum wage is 14.25. The university benchmarks its pay against a living wage of 15.40, and 100% of employees receive remuneration equivalent to at least this living wage.

In terms of parental leave, the university provides 26 of paid maternity leave. Under national legislation, female employees are entitled to a total of forty-two weeks of maternity leave, consisting of twenty-six weeks fully paid by the university and/or the Department of Social Welfare, and an additional sixteen weeks of unpaid leave. Paid all-gender family or medical leave is available, with 100% of employees eligible.

The university has published a Gender Pay Gap Report, which indicates progress in reducing the pay gap. This gap is driven by representation patterns rather than unequal pay for equal work. Specifically, there are fewer women in higher-paid senior academic and professional roles, and more women in lower-paid, entry-grade, or part-time roles. To address this, the university plans to implement the requirements of the EU Gender Pay Transparency Directive, expand support for staff returning from career breaks, monitor the uptake of flexible working policies by gender, and introduce wellbeing metrics in staff surveys.

Occupational Health and Safety

The university maintains a Safety Representative Forum to enhance the safety, health, and welfare of employees, safeguard students, and secure legal compliance through consultation. Staff safety representatives represent employees on health and safety matters, conduct workplace safety tours upon request, review accident and dangerous occurrence reports, and contribute to initiatives aimed at improving the safety culture.

To promote worker health, the university provides physical and behavioural health services, free or reduced-cost fitness activities, and contemplative or spiritual activities. Smoking and tobacco use are not prohibited across the entire campus, with restrictions limited to specific areas.

Workforce Diversity

The university tracks diversity across its workforce categories. The ethnic diversity index is 0 for executive staff, 0.44 for academic staff, and 0.34 for non-academic staff.

In terms of gender diversity, 47% of executive staff identify as women or other marginalised gender identities. For regular permanent academic staff, this figure is 49%, and for regular permanent non-academic staff, it is 63%. To further understand the

diversity profile of its workforce, the university plans to launch an Employee Self-Service Diversity tool to collect data across all equality grounds.

Limitations and Gaps in Reporting

Several limitations exist in the current reporting framework:

- **GRI 202-1:** The student minimum wage 14.25 represents the local statutory minimum for student workers rather than the general workforce. While the ratio of standard entry-level wage to minimum wage can be derived, the required breakdown by gender is unanswerable. The living wage 15.40 is a separate benchmark and cannot be substituted for the minimum wage. All monetary values are in Euros and cannot be compared directly with other currencies without conversion.
- **GRI 401-2:** The eligibility rate for paid all-gender family and medical leave 100% is reported as a single institution-wide figure, meaning the comparison between full-time and part-time or temporary employees cannot be drawn.
- **GRI 401-3:** Headcounts, uptake, and retention rates for parental leave are not reported; only the policy of 26 of paid maternity leave is recorded, which is narrower than all-gender parental leave.
- **GRI 403-1, GRI 403-3, GRI 403-4, GRI 403-6, GRI 403-8:** The legal basis, standards, and worker coverage of the management system are not recorded. General health promotion services are reported, but specific occupational health functions, hazard identification, and data confidentiality are not detailed. The Safety Representative Forum's meeting frequency, decision-making authority, and exact representation are not fully documented. Campus smoking restrictions do not constitute a complete ban.
- **GRI 405-1:** Gender diversity is reported as a combined figure for women and marginalised gender identities rather than a detailed split. Age-group breakdowns are unavailable, and the representation percentage on the highest governance body is not recorded. Ethnic diversity is reported as a concentration index rather than a percentage breakdown.

The following disclosures are not reported: GRI 202-2 (local hiring of senior management), GRI 204-1 (local procurement spend, as social impact spend is measured instead), GRI 401-1 (new hires and turnover), GRI 403-2 (hazard identification and risk assessment processes), GRI 403-5 (health and safety training), GRI 403-7 (business relationship impacts), GRI 403-9 (work-related injuries), GRI 403-10 (work-related ill health), and GRI 405-2 (ratio of basic salary and remuneration of women to men).

GRI content index

Reported	Partially reported	Not reported	Not assessed
26	14	38	0

“With reference to”, not “in accordance with.” GRI reserves in accordance for reports answering every Universal Disclosure (GRI 2) plus all disclosures for each material topic. This report does not, so it uses the weaker and correct claim.

GRI 2: General Disclosures 2021

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
2-1 Organizational details	Reported	Institutional control: Public	GRI 2-1 also requires the legal name, the location of headquarters and the countries of operation. STARS carries none of these as fields — they are report metadata, not credit data.
2-2 Entities included in the organization’s sustainability reporting	Reported	Narrative outlining the institutional boundary used to complete this report: This submission covers all of UCC main campus and satellite campuses that are under the...	GRI 2-2-b/c additionally ask whether the reporting entities differ from those in the financial statements and how minority interests are consolidated. STARS asks neither.
2-3 Reporting period, frequency and contact point	Partially reported	Performance year for scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions: 2024 List of personnel who led the reporting process: Dr Maria Kirrane, Head of Sustainability and Climate	STARS has no single reporting period, and the per-credit years diverge inside one submission: Cork’s credits run from 2023 (construction waste) to 2025 (living wage, investment), Berkeley’s from 2023 to 2024. Only TU Dublin is uniform, at 2023. Any single period stated for a GRI report built on this data would be wrong for some of its figures. GRI 2-3 also requires the reporting frequency, the publication date and a contact point; STARS collects none of these. Named preparers are not a designated contact point: STARS records names and roles without contact details, and does not say who should receive enquiries.
2-4 Restatements of information	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	STARS v2.2 and earlier scored Operations credits against the institution’s own baseline and v3.0 scores against a peer group, so cross-version figures are not comparable in the first place — see CLAUDE.md 6.4.
2-5 External assurance	Reported	Were any independent audits or external assurance processes used in the preparation of this report?: Yes Narrative outlining the independent audits or external assurance processes used in the preparation of this report: Emissions figures were verified by the University’s contracted carbon footprint provide...	GRI 2-5 additionally requires the assurance standard used, the level of assurance obtained, the limitations of the process and the relationship with the assurance provider. STARS captures none of these; the free-text field is optional and unstructured. Only populated where the institution answered yes to the assurance question, so it is absent for most submissions.

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
2-6 Activities, value chain and other business relationships	Partially reported	Which of the following features are included within the institutional boundary?: Medical school Museum Satellite campus(es)	GRI 2-6 asks for the sectors the organization is active in, its value chain, its products and services and the markets served. A list of campus features covers only the activities, and only those with a physical footprint.
2-7 Employees	Partially reported	Full-time equivalent of employees: 3,643	FTE is not a headcount: two half-time staff count as one. GRI 2-7 further requires the breakdown by employment contract (permanent / temporary), by employment type (full- / part-time), by gender and by region. STARS collects a single undifferentiated figure.
2-8 Workers who are not employees	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
2-9 Governance structure and composition	Reported	Are one or more academic staff representatives included as members of the institution's highest decision-making body?: Yes Are one or more staff members representing non-managerial workers included as members of the institution's highest decision-making body?: Yes Are one or more student representatives included as members of the institution's highest decision-making body?: Yes Narrative and/or website URL outlining academic staff representation on the institution's highest decision-making body: Two spaces on the UCC Governing Authority democratically elected by staff of UCC. https://www.ucc.ie/en/about/our-structure/governance/	GRI 2-9 also requires the number of executive and non-executive members, their independence, tenure, other significant positions held, and composition by gender and under-represented social group. STARS records only whether each constituency is represented. See the caveat on the academic-staff row: representation is recorded, composition is not. See the caveat on the academic-staff row. Free text of variable depth; it is not a substitute for the numeric composition GRI 2-9-c requires.
2-10 Nomination and selection of the highest governance body	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
2-11 Chair of the highest governance body	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
2-12 Role of the highest governance body in overseeing the management of impacts	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
2-13 Delegation of responsibility for managing impacts	Reported	Does the institution have one or more sustainability officers?: Yes Is at least one of the institution's sustainability committees, officers, or offices charged with coordinating various campus constituencies in the advancement of sustainability across the entire institution?: Yes Narrative and/or website URL providing an overview of the institution's sustainability officers: Dr Maria Kirrane is the University's Head of Sustainability and Climate Action, while S...	GRI 2-13-b also requires whether and how often those executives report to the highest governance body. STARS does not ask. See the caveat on the sustainability-officer row. Free text; the reporting line to the highest governance body is not consistently stated.
2-14 Role of the highest governance body in sustainability reporting	Partially reported	Executive cover letter: 03.03.26-STARSProgrammeSubmission.pdf	Endorsement by a senior executive is not review and approval by the highest governance body, and STARS records neither who approved the content nor whether material topics were reviewed. The field value is an attachment filename, so the letter's text is not in the dataset.
2-15 Conflicts of interest	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
2-16 Communication of critical concerns	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
2-17 Collective knowledge of the highest governance body	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
2-18 Evaluation of the performance of the highest governance body	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
2-19 Remuneration policies	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
2-20 Process to determine remuneration	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
2-21 Annual total compensation ratio	Not reported	Mapped to STARS, but this institution left every mapped field blank.	The denominator differs and the difference is large. GRI 2-21 divides the highest-paid individual by the MEDIAN of all other employees; STARS divides the highest-paid senior administrator by the LOWEST-paid full-time employee. The STARS figure is therefore a top-to-bottom spread, not a top-to-typical ratio, and is not comparable with any GRI 2-21 figure published elsewhere. IL-62 is also an Innovation & Leadership bonus credit, so it is optional: only TU Dublin reports it (8.08); Berkeley and Cork leave it blank.
2-22 Statement on sustainable development strategy	Partially reported	Narrative detailing the institution's guiding vision or goals for sustainability and the plan(s) in which they are published: The Sustainability and Climate Action Plan (2023-2028) builds on the successes of UCC's...	GRI 2-22 requires the statement to come from the highest governance body or the most senior executive. STARS records the institution's published vision without attributing it to a named signatory, so the authorship the disclosure turns on is absent.
2-23 Policy commitments	Reported	Has the institution made a public commitment to sustainability, as evidenced by an external commitment or a published plan?: Yes Narrative and/or website URL outlining the institution's external sustainability commitments that include a reporting requirement: UCC is required by the Irish government to reduce our absolute GHG emissions by 51% by ...	GRI 2-23 specifically requires commitments to respect human rights, to the UN Guiding Principles and to due diligence. A sustainability commitment is broader and does not imply any of these. STARS asks only for commitments carrying a reporting requirement, so commitments without one are out of scope of the field.
2-24 Embedding policy commitments	Reported	Does the institution have a published code of conduct to guide suppliers on the institution's social and environmental expectations for them?: Yes Does the institution make available sustainability-focused training opportunities to non-academic staff on at least an annual basis?: Yes Narrative outlining the activities and substantive accomplishments of the institution-wide coordinating body or officer during the previous three years: The Head of Sustainability and Climate Action coordinates the Office of Sustainability ...	GRI 2-24 also requires how responsibility is allocated internally and how the commitments are embedded in strategies and procedures. STARS asks about non-academic staff only, and about sustainability training generally rather than training on the specific commitments. It describes outcomes, not the allocation of responsibility, the integration into procedures, or the handling of commitments through business relationships that GRI 2-24-a enumerates.
2-25 Processes to remediate negative impacts	Partially reported	Does the institution publish information on grievance resolution in a format that is accessible to all employees?: Yes	STARS records only that the information is published — not how the mechanism operates, who may use it, or its effectiveness — and covers employees only, where GRI 2-25 covers all affected stakeholders.

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
2-26 Mechanisms for seeking advice and raising concerns	Reported	Does the institution publish information on whistleblower protections in a format that is accessible to all employees?: Yes Narrative and/or website URL providing an overview of the institution's published measures to protect employee rights: https://www.ucc.ie/en/edi/sexual-violence-harassment-framework/ https://www.ucc.ie/en/h...	STARS records publication, not a description of how the mechanism operates, and covers employees only. GRI 2-26 extends to all individuals, including those in business relationships. Employees only; see the caveat on the whistleblower row.
2-27 Compliance with laws and regulations	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
2-28 Membership associations	Partially reported	Narrative and/or website URL outlining the institution's external sustainability commitments that include a reporting requirement: UCC is required by the Irish government to reduce our absolute GHG emissions by 51% by ...	Signing a charter is not membership of an association, and STARS restricts the field to commitments carrying a reporting requirement. The institution's association memberships are not collected as such.
2-29 Approach to stakeholder engagement	Reported	Description of other mechanisms used to consult students on institutional decisions, plans, or policies: Born from UCC's strategic plan, the UCC Student Forum is an exercise in deliberative an... Description of other mechanisms used to consult academic staff on institutional decisions, plans, or policies: The Academic Leadership Forum in UCC is Non-executive forum for academic leadership of ... Narrative and/or website URL outlining the ad hoc mechanisms used during the previous three years to consult local community members on institutional decisions, plans, or policies: UCC supports and actively engages with the local Magazine Road Residents Association, e... Does the institution have one or more ongoing bodies through which local community-based organizations not affiliated with the institution can democratically participate in its governance?: Yes	GRI 2-29 also asks how stakeholders are identified and how the organization ensures the engagement is meaningful. STARS asks about four fixed constituencies and does not cover suppliers, customers or vulnerable groups. See the caveat on the student-consultation row.
2-30 Collective bargaining agreements	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	

GRI 3: Material Topics 2021

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
3-1 Process to determine material topics	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	This is a structural difference, not missing data. AASHE determined materiality for the whole higher-education sector when it designed the STARS credit set; the institution answers that fixed set rather than identifying its own impacts. PA-2 records a climate-vulnerability assessment and PA-3 records stakeholder consultation, but neither is a materiality process and neither should be presented as one.
3-2 List of material topics	Partially reported	Has the institution adopted one or more measurable sustainability objectives that address campus operations?: Yes Has the institution adopted one or more measurable sustainability objectives that address teaching, learning, and/or research?: Yes Has the institution adopted one or more measurable sustainability objectives that address racial equity and/or social justice?: Yes Has the institution adopted one or more measurable sustainability objectives that address administration and/or finance?: Yes Has the institution adopted one or more measurable sustainability objectives that address campus and/or community engagement?: Yes	NOT A MATERIALITY DETERMINATION. These five areas are fixed by STARS and identical for every institution, so they say where an institution has set objectives, not which impacts it judged significant and why. GRI 3-2-b also requires changes against the previous reporting period, which a single STARS submission cannot show. Presenting these as material topics would overstate what the institution actually did. See the campus-operations row: fixed areas, not a materiality determination.

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
3-3 Management of material topics	Partially reported	Narrative listing the institution's measurable sustainability objectives that address campus operations: Within the University's Sustainability and Climate Action Plan 2023-28, UCC has committ... Narrative outlining the activities and substantive accomplishments of the institution-wide coordinating body or officer during the previous three years: The Head of Sustainability and Climate Action coordinates the Office of Sustainability ... Has the institution made a public commitment to sustainability, as evidenced by an external commitment or a published plan?: Yes	Asked per material topic, and no material-topics list exists (see GRI 3-2) — so these are institution-wide answers to a question GRI asks topic by topic. GRI 3-3 also requires the impacts themselves (3-3-a), whether the organisation is involved through its own activities or its business relationships (3-3-b), and lessons learned (3-3-e-iv). STARS collects none of those. It reports outcomes rather than distinguishing actions that prevent potential harm from actions that remediate actual harm, which is the split GRI 3-3-d asks for.

GRI 202: Market Presence 2016

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
202-1 Ratios of standard entry level wage by gender compared to local minimum wage	Reported	Percentage of employees that receive remuneration equivalent to at least a living wage: 100 Living wage: 15.40 Wage floor for regular/permanent employees: 16.40 Local hourly minimum wage for students: 14.25	PARTIALLY SATISFIES GRI 202-1, AND THE RATIO IS DERIVABLE. Both terms are in STARS: PA-13's Wage floor for regular/permanent employees is the standard entry-level wage, and PA-9's Local hourly minimum wage for students is the local statutory minimum. Berkeley 22.54/16.99 = 1.33, Cork 16.40/14.25 = 1.15, TU Dublin 16.53/12.70 = 1.30. △ TWO LIMITS REMAIN. The minimum-wage field sits in a student-employment credit, so it is the minimum applying to student workers rather than one stated for the workforce generally — in all three cases it matches the statutory local minimum, but say which figure is being used. And GRI requires the ratio BY GENDER, which STARS does not collect at any credit; that half is unanswerable, not merely unsupplied. STARS separately benchmarks pay against a LIVING wage, which is a different and higher threshold than the minimum wage and must not be substituted for it. Values are bare numbers with no currency - EUR for the Irish universities, USD for Berkeley - and are not comparable across them without saying so. It lives in PA-9, a student-employment credit, so it is the minimum applying to student workers. In all three cases it matches the local statutory minimum (Berkeley 16.99, the City of Berkeley rate; Cork 14.25; TU Dublin 12.70, Ireland's national minimum), but the scoping should be stated rather than glossed.

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
202-2 Proportion of senior management hired from the local community	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	No STARS credit collects this.

GRI 204: Procurement Practices 2016

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
204-1 Proportion of spending on local suppliers	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	

GRI 301: Materials 2016

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
301-1 Materials used by weight or volume	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	This is a sector-fit finding of the same kind as AC-1 and EN-1 on the STARS side: the framework and the institution type do not line up.
301-2 Recycled input materials used	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
301-3 Reclaimed products and their packaging materials	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	

GRI 302: Energy 2016

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
302-1 Energy consumption within the organization	Reported	Total annual energy consumption: 55,148.70 Megawatt-hours Total electricity consumption: 32,599.70 Megawatt-hours Total stationary fuel consumption: 22,549 Megawatt-hours Annual renewable energy consumption: 0.70 Megawatt-hours Renewable stationary fuels: 0 Megawatt-hours Total heating and cooling from off-site sources: 0 Megawatt-hours On-site renewable electricity exported: 0 Megawatt-hours Natural gas: 22,549 Megawatt-hours Heating oil: 0 Megawatt-hours Coal/coke: 0 Megawatt-hours Propane/LPG: 0 Megawatt-hours	GRI 302-1 expects joules or multiples and requires fuel consumption split into renewable and non-renewable. STARS reports megawatt-hours - convertible, but state the conversion. SCOPE MISMATCH. GRI 302-1-b is 'Total fuel consumption from renewable sources'. This STARS field also includes renewable ELECTRICITY (Berkeley 18,173 MWh), so it is broader than GRI's line and would overstate renewable fuel. The precise match is 'Renewable stationary fuels' - see the row below, which is ~0 for all three. Use this field only for a general renewables statement, never for GRI 302-1-b. Correct but near-empty: 0.21 MWh for TU Dublin, 0 for Cork and Berkeley. A finding in itself - these universities' renewable energy is almost entirely purchased electricity, not renewable fuel. GRI 302-1-b is therefore honestly reportable as ~zero. GRI 302-1 requires joules; STARS reports MMBtu or MWh, so the value must be converted before it is cited as a GRI figure. Zero for all three institutions in the current reporting year, so the mapping is correct but currently carries no signal. GRI 302-1 expects joules; STARS reports MWh — convertible, but state the conversion. Zero at Cork; a small residual at TU Dublin and Berkeley. Units are MWh, not joules. A reported zero, not missing data. STARS also carries an Other stationary fuels catch-all, also zero everywhere, which is what makes this list of fuel types complete rather than merely partial.
302-2 Energy consumption outside of the organization	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
302-3 Energy intensity	Reported	Annual energy consumption per person: 2,139.20 Kilowatt-hours Annual energy consumption per unit of floor area: 195.31 Kilowatt-hours per square meter	Denominator (FTE students + employees) must be disclosed with the ratio. Denominator is gross floor area; must be disclosed with the ratio.
302-4 Reduction of energy consumption	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
302-5 Reductions in energy requirements of products and services	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	

GRI 303: Water and Effluents 2018

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
303-1 Interactions with water as a shared resource	Reported	Level of physical water quantity risk for the institution's main campus: Low-medium Does the institution harvest rainwater on-site for storage and use?: Yes	A risk grade is not the description GRI 303-1 asks for: it says nothing about how water is withdrawn, consumed or discharged, how the impacts were identified, or how the institution works with stakeholders on shared water resources. It also covers the main campus only, where a multi-campus institution has several. Only one of the three institutions quantifies the volume harvested; the other two answer the yes/no only.
303-2 Management of water discharge-related impacts	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
303-3 Water withdrawal	Reported	Total water withdrawal: 54,153 Cubic meters Potable water from off-site sources: 54,153 Cubic meters Potable water from on-site sources: 0 Cubic meters	GRI 303-3 requires a breakdown by source AND a separate figure for areas with water stress. STARS collects neither, so 303-3 cannot be fully satisfied from STARS alone. UNITS: GRI 303-3 requires megaliters and STARS reports cubic meters. Divide by 1,000 before citing the figure as a GRI 303-3 value, and state the conversion — the same treatment GRI 302-1 gets for megawatt-hours against joules. Maps to the specific GRI 303-3-a-v category 'Third-party water'. It is the ONLY withdrawal source these universities have — on-site abstraction is zero for all three — so this equals the total. Zero for all three institutions, which is itself the finding: none of them abstracts its own water. Retained so the GRI 303-3 source breakdown is complete rather than silent.

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
303-4 Water discharge	Not reported	Assessed: the nearest STARS field (OP-3 / Annual volume of water recovered and/or returned) was reviewed and rejected as an answer to this disclosure.	GRI 303-4 requires discharge by destination, freshwater/other water split, and treatment level. STARS captures none of that. Weak mapping - verify before use.
303-5 Water consumption	Not reported	Assessed: the nearest STARS field (OP-3 / Annual potable water use) was reviewed and rejected as an answer to this disclosure.	DEFINITIONS DIFFER. GRI 303-5 water consumption = withdrawal minus discharge. STARS 'annual potable water use' is potable supply only and is not computed that way. Do not present this as GRI 303-5 without recomputing.

GRI 305: Emissions 2016

305-1 Direct (Scope 1) GHG emissions	Reported	Annual scope 1 GHG emissions: 6,215.78 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Scope 1 GHG emissions from stationary combustion: 5,517 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Scope 1 GHG emissions from mobile combustion: 62.78 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Scope 1 GHG fugitive emissions: 636 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent GHG emissions from biogenic sources: 0 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Baseline year for scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions: 2017 Baseline scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions: 19,460 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Narrative outlining when and why the GHG emissions baseline was adopted: This is the emissions baseline that has been set by the government of Ireland for all p... Description of the methodology or calculator used to conduct the scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions inventory: Calculated by our contracted supplier Sustineo to GHG Protocol standards and ISO 14064-...	GRI 305-1 additionally requires biogenic CO2 to be reported separately from the gross figure. GRI asks for biogenic CO2 specifically; the STARS field is CO2-equivalent and may not be the same boundary. STARS reports ONE baseline covering scope 1 and scope 2 together. GRI states the base year separately for 305-1 and 305-2, so this figure serves both jointly and neither alone — it cannot be split. So it answers 305-1-d-ii and 305-2-d-ii only as a combined total, which is weaker than either disclosure asks for on its own. GRI additionally requires the source of the emission factors and GWP rates (305-1-e) and the consolidation approach (305-1-f); STARS collects neither. Not populated by this institution: OP-6 / Scope 1 GHG process emissions.
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Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
305-2 Energy indirect (Scope 2) GHG emissions	Reported	Annual scope 2 GHG emissions: 8,144 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Scope 2 GHG emissions from off-site sources of electricity (market-based): 8,144 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Scope 2 GHG emissions from off-site sources of electricity (location-based): 8,144 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Scope 2 GHG emissions from off-site sources of heating and cooling: 0 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Baseline year for scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions: 2017 Baseline scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions: 19,460 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Narrative outlining when and why the GHG emissions baseline was adopted: This is the emissions baseline that has been set by the government of Ireland for all p... Description of the methodology or calculator used to conduct the scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions inventory: Calculated by our contracted supplier Sustineo to GHG Protocol standards and ISO 14064-...	GRI 305-2 requires location-based and, where available, market-based figures reported separately. Do not present a single scope 2 number without saying which method. STARS reports ONE baseline covering scope 1 and scope 2 together. GRI states the base year separately for 305-1 and 305-2, so this figure serves both jointly and neither alone — it cannot be split. So it answers 305-1-d-ii and 305-2-d-ii only as a combined total, which is weaker than either disclosure asks for on its own. GRI additionally requires the source of the emission factors and GWP rates (305-2-e) and the consolidation approach (305-2-f); STARS collects neither.

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
305-3 Other indirect (Scope 3) GHG emissions	Reported	Scope 3 GHG emissions from business travel: 3,565 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Scope 3 GHG emissions from commuting: 20,991 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Scope 3 GHG emissions from purchased goods and services: 1,572 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Scope 3 GHG emissions from capital goods: 0 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Scope 3 GHG emissions from fuel- and energy-related activities not included in scope 1 or scope 2: 3,318 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent	Not populated by this institution: OP-6 / Scope 3 GHG emissions from waste generated in operations.
305-4 GHG emissions intensity	Reported	Annual scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions per person: 557.01 Kilograms of CO2 equivalent Annual scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions per unit of floor area: 50.86 Kilograms per square meter	GRI 305-4 requires the denominator to be stated. Here it is FTE students + employees, not a corporate revenue or output metric. Denominator is gross floor area in square meters; must be disclosed alongside the ratio.

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
305-5 Reduction of GHG emissions	Reported	Percentage reduction in scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions from baseline: 26.21 Baseline scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions: 19,460 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Baseline year for scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions: 2017 Narrative outlining when and why the GHG emissions baseline was adopted: This is the emissions baseline that has been set by the government of Ireland for all p... Adjusted net scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions: 14,359.78 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Third party certified carbon offsets: 0 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent	GRI 305-5 asks for reductions as an ABSOLUTE quantity in metric tons CO2e; STARS gives a percentage. △ THAT PERCENTAGE IS NET OF PURCHASED OFFSETS. STARS computes it from Adjusted net scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions, not from the gross total printed alongside it, so the two do not reconcile wherever an institution holds offsets: Berkeley's reduction is 6.54% gross and 9.83% net, a third of the headline figure being bought rather than achieved. Cork and TU Dublin agree on both bases only because their offsets are zero. Deriving the absolute reduction as baseline minus current gives the GROSS figure — correct, but not the number STARS prints. Say which basis is being quoted, and report the offsets separately as GRI 305-5's compilation requirement 2.9.5 demands. Derive it; do not present the baseline itself as a reduction. The subtraction is only valid because both figures cover the same combined scope 1 + 2 boundary. STARS reports ONE baseline covering scope 1 and scope 2 together. GRI states the base year separately for 305-1 and 305-2, so this figure serves both jointly and neither alone — it cannot be split. GRI 305-5-b (gases included) and 305-5-d (which scopes the reductions occurred in) remain unanswered — STARS reports the reduction against the combined scope 1 + 2 total without attributing it to either. GROSS AND NET DIVERGE WHERE OFFSETS EXIST. Berkeley's reduction is 6.54% gross and 9.83% net; Cork's and TU Dublin's are identical either way because they hold no offsets. State which basis is being quoted. Berkeley holds 4,858 tCO2e of third-party certified offsets, which is the entire difference between its gross and adjusted-net reduction — about a third of the headline figure. STARS also reports a Net carbon sinks field which is CAPPED and does NOT equal the deduction actually applied, so do not use it to reconcile the two percentages.
305-6 Emissions of ozone-depleting substances (ODS)	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	STARS 3.0 collects no ODS data at any credit. Cannot be reported from this dataset.
305-7 Nitrogen oxides (NOx), sulfur oxides (SOx), and other significant air emissions	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	STARS 3.0 collects no criteria-air-pollutant data. Cannot be reported from this dataset.

GRI 306: Waste 2020

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
306-1 Waste generation and significant waste-related impacts	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
306-2 Management of significant waste-related impacts	Reported	Does the institution have a surplus program through which institution-owned items that are no longer needed are stored for eventual sale, donation, or reuse?: Yes Does the institution have or participate in a reuse program through which employees and/or students can donate personal items for redistribution?: Yes Has the institution eliminated the on-site use of at least one form of single-use disposable plastic?: Yes Does the institution have a hazardous waste management program or protocol that includes measures to minimize or reduce the use of hazardous materials?: Yes Narrative and/or website URL providing an overview of the institution's composting program: Compostable lunchboxes are accepted in the University's food waste bins. Does the institution have sufficient data on construction and demolition waste to pursue this indicator?: Yes	GRI 306-3 additionally requires hazardous waste to be quantified separately from non-hazardous. STARS quantifies only non-hazardous and construction-and-demolition waste, so the tonnage is unavailable. It states data sufficiency as a yes/no rather than describing the collection process, and covers construction and demolition waste only.

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
306-3 Waste generated	Reported	Annual non-hazardous waste generated: 520 Metric tons Annual construction and demolition waste generated: 6,914.08 Metric tons	NOT EQUIVALENT - a subset. GRI 306-3-a is TOTAL waste generated including hazardous, broken down by composition. STARS reports non-hazardous only and collects no hazardous tonnage at any credit, so 306-3 cannot be fully satisfied. Do not present non-hazardous waste as the organisation's total waste. (Contrast the 306-4 and 306-5 rows, which are component : GRI has explicit non-hazardous lines at 306-4-c and 306-5-c for the STARS figures to answer, whereas 306-3 has no non-hazardous sub-requirement at all — which is why this row is weaker than those two, not equal to them.)
306-4 Waste diverted from disposal	Reported	Total non-hazardous waste diverted from disposal: 242 Metric tons Non-hazardous waste recycled: 183 Metric tons Non-hazardous waste composted: 59 Metric tons Non-hazardous waste prepared for reuse: 0 Metric tons Total construction and demolition waste diverted from disposal: 6,837.95 Metric tons Construction and demolition waste recycled: 5,675.22 Metric tons Construction and demolition waste prepared for reuse: 1,162.73 Metric tons	Exact scope match on GRI 306-4-c, including its split by recovery operation (reuse / recycling / other) from the rows below. GRI 306-4-d additionally wants each operation split on-site vs off-site, which STARS does not collect. NOT THE WHOLE DISCLOSURE: the hazardous half is absent. STARS weighs no hazardous waste anywhere — OP-11 records only whether a hazardous-waste programme exists and describes it in prose. For a research university that is a materially significant stream going unreported, and it is a finding about STARS rather than about these institutions. Reuse is a higher-value recovery route than recycling under the waste hierarchy, so omitting it understates the quality of diversion as well as the arithmetic. Cork recovers 1,162.73 of 6,837.95 tonnes this way.
306-5 Waste directed to disposal	Reported	Non-hazardous waste disposed of to a landfill or incinerator: 278 Metric tons Construction and demolition waste disposed of to a landfill or incinerator: 76.13 Metric tons	WEAKER THAN THE 306-4 EQUIVALENT: GRI 306-5-c also requires the total split across four disposal operations — incineration with energy recovery, incineration without, landfilling, other — and STARS merges landfill and incineration into a single figure. The waste-to-energy percentage field would separate incineration with recovery, but only two of the three institutions report it, so the split cannot be derived consistently. NOT THE WHOLE DISCLOSURE: the hazardous half is absent. STARS weighs no hazardous waste anywhere — OP-11 records only whether a hazardous-waste programme exists and describes it in prose. For a research university that is a materially significant stream going unreported, and it is a finding about STARS rather than about these institutions.

GRI 308: Supplier Environmental Assessment 2016

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
308-1 New suppliers that were screened using environmental criteria	Partially reported	Does the institution's supplier code of conduct include one or more expectations in regard to environmental impact that exceed or are additional to regulatory compliance?: No Percentage of bid solicitations that identify supplier sustainability considerations: 21	GRI 308-1 requires a percentage of new suppliers actually screened. STARS reports the existence of the criteria, not their application to any supplier, so no percentage can be derived. The denominator is bid solicitations, not new suppliers, and one solicitation may attract many suppliers or none. 'Sustainability considerations' is also broader than the environmental criteria GRI 308-1 specifies. The figure is 0 percent at TU Dublin, so a low value here should not be read as a screening failure without checking the product-specification field alongside it.
308-2 Negative environmental impacts in the supply chain and actions taken	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	

GRI 401: Employment 2016

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
401-1 New employee hires and employee turnover	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	STARS 3.0 collects no hiring or turnover figures.
401-2 Benefits provided to full-time employees that are not provided to temporary or part-time employees	Partially reported	Percentage of employees eligible for paid all-gender family/medical leave: 100	GRI 401-2 turns on the contrast between full-time employees and temporary or part-time employees, and asks for the benefits by significant location of operation. STARS gives a single institution-wide eligibility rate with no employment-type split, so the comparison the disclosure exists to make cannot be drawn.
401-3 Parental leave	Partially reported	Number of weeks of paid maternity leave: 26 Narrative and/or website URL providing an overview of the maternity leave options available to employees: Under the maternity legislation all women are entitled to 42 weeks maternity leave. Pay...	GRI 401-3 requires headcounts by gender: employees entitled to parental leave, those who took it, those who returned, those still employed twelve months later, and the resulting return-to-work and retention rates. STARS reports none of these — it reports the policy, not its uptake. 'Maternity' is also narrower than GRI's 'parental'. Descriptive only; supplies none of the headcounts or rates GRI 401-3 requires.

GRI 403: Occupational Health and Safety 2018

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
403-1 Occupational health and safety management system	Partially reported	Narrative and/or website URL providing an overview of the institution's workplace health and safety committees: The University has a Safety Representative Forum. The aim of the Forum is to enhance th...	STARS never asks the 403-1 question, so an answer only appears where the institution volunteered it. Nothing records whether the system exists because of a legal requirement, which standard it follows, or which workers, activities and workplaces it covers — that is 403-1-b, and it is absent.
403-2 Hazard identification, risk assessment, and incident investigation	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
403-3 Occupational health services	Partially reported	Does the institution make physical health services available to employees?: Yes	General employee health services are not occupational health services: GRI 403-3 is about the function that identifies and eliminates workplace hazards, and about how worker health data is kept confidential. STARS asks about neither.
403-4 Worker participation, consultation, and communication on occupational health and safety	Reported	Does the institution have an institution-wide health and safety committee or network of committees that brings together workers and management in the development and review of workplace health and safety policies and procedures?: Yes Narrative and/or website URL providing an overview of the institution's workplace health and safety committees: The University has a Safety Representative Forum. The aim of the Forum is to enhance th...	GRI 403-4-b further requires the committee's responsibilities, meeting frequency, decision-making authority, and whether any workers are unrepresented. STARS records existence only. Depth varies by institution; meeting frequency and decision-making authority are not consistently stated.
403-5 Worker training on occupational health and safety	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
403-6 Promotion of worker health	Reported	Does the institution make physical health services available to employees?: Yes Does the institution make behavioral health services available to employees?: Yes Does the institution make free or reduced cost fitness activities available to employees?: Yes Does the institution prohibit smoking and tobacco use across the entire campus?: No Does the institution make contemplative and/or spiritual activities available to employees?: Yes	GRI 403-6-a also requires the scope of access provided; STARS records availability as a yes/no, with the scope left to the narrative. A prohibition is a control rather than a voluntary promotion service; STARS also records the weaker variants (indoor-only, restricted outdoor smoking) in separate fields.
403-7 Prevention and mitigation of occupational health and safety impacts directly linked by business relationships	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
403-8 Workers covered by an occupational health and safety management system	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
403-9 Work-related injuries	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	PA-11 (Health, Safety and Wellbeing) contains no injury figures - its only numeric fields are STARS scoring artefacts. Cannot be reported.
403-10 Work-related ill health	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	PA-11 contains no ill-health figures. Cannot be reported.

GRI 405: Diversity and Equal Opportunity 2016

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
405-1 Diversity of governance bodies and employees	Reported	Ethnic diversity index for executive staff: 0 Percentage of executive staff that identify as women or other marginalized gender identities: 47 Percentage of regular/permanent academic staff that identify as women or other marginalized gender identities: 49 Percentage of regular/permanent non-academic staff that identify as women or other marginalized gender identities: 63 Ethnic diversity index for academic staff: 0.44 Ethnic diversity index for non-academic staff: 0.34	This is a diversity INDEX (a single 0-1 concentration score), not the percentage breakdown GRI 405-1-b asks for. It shows how mixed the group is, not what share each group holds. No STARS credit collects employee age at all, so GRI 405-1's age-group split (under 30 / 30-50 / over 50) is unanswerable for every employee category. 405-1-a is still not answered: STARS PA-3 records which constituencies are represented on the highest decision-making body, never what percentage of that body they make up. DATA QUALITY: TU Dublin's value is the string '0 Revised on Nov. 24, 2025' — annotation text concatenated onto the figure — so the field is typed <code>text</code>, not <code>number</code>, and will not parse. Cork and Berkeley are clean. STARS reports one combined figure for 'women or other marginalized gender identities' rather than a percentage per gender, so the split GRI asks for is two buckets, not three.
405-2 Ratio of basic salary and remuneration of women to men	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	STARS FIELDS: nothing. PA-13 covers living-wage coverage and wage floors, not a gender pay ratio — despite the credit being named 'Pay Equity'. BUT the evidence documents linked from STARS answers partially close this: UCC publishes V3EDIGenderPayGapReport2025.pdf and TU Dublin Gender-Pay-Gap-Report-2023-FINALv1.pdf, both stating a mean gender pay gap. Berkeley links no equivalent. NOT a substitute for 405-2: GRI wants the ratio of basic salary and remuneration of women to men PER EMPLOYEE CATEGORY and per significant location; these reports give one organisation-wide percentage. Reportable as context with the source named, for 2 of 3 institutions, and it must be read out of the PDF by a human — it is not in any structured field, so it cannot go through the Jinja2 number path.

Verifying this report

Every figure above is recorded in `report/output/index_provenance.csv` with the exact STARS credit and field it came from, so any number can be traced to a row of the source dataset without trusting the generator. `tests/test_content_index.py` re-derives them independently of the code that produced them.